

## Data Sorting

### Learning Objectives

- Sort data in ascending and descending order
- Sort by single and multiple columns
- Use sort to organize records meaningfully

### Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think of a library shelf where books are arranged by subject, then by author name within each subject. Sorting in spreadsheets works the same way—it organizes data so you can find information quickly, whether alphabetical, numerical, or by category.

### Explore (10-12 minutes)

Enter student data: Names in A1:A8, Marks in B1:B8, Subjects in C1:C8. Sort by Marks (descending) to find toppers. Sort by Names (alphabetical) to organize the list. Then sort by Subjects first, then by Marks within each subject. Observe how the data rearranges.

### Explain (10-12 minutes)

Sorting rearranges rows based on cell values. Ascending order is A-Z or 0-9; descending is Z-A or 9-0. Single-column sort orders by one column. Multi-column sort first orders by primary column, then by secondary column within groups. Always select all related columns before sorting to keep records intact.

### Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Create a village census spreadsheet: Names, Age, Occupation, Family Size. Sort by Occupation to group farmers together. Within farmers, sort by Age. Find the oldest and youngest farmer. Sort by Family Size to see largest families. Write which sorting helped answer which question.

### Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Answer: What happens if you sort only the Marks column without Names? When would you use multi-column sort? Sort your data by three different columns and describe what each sort reveals.